

4 Mobile Platforms

hyperlink within a message, you can select to go to that page or if a phone number is listed, you can dial out directly from that message as well.

4.3.4 Windows Live Services

Windows Mobile 6 puts Live Mail (formerly Hotmail) and Live Messenger literally front and center. If you have a Hotmail/Windows Live email account, you can easily access those messages with Windows Live for Mobile. It's a simple matter of inputting your user ID and password, then you can choose to synchronise your Outlook and Windows Live email and contacts, which integrates nicely into your phone's address book.

We've seen MSN Messenger on Windows Mobile devices in the past, but we have to say Messenger was pretty basic and lame, and we ended up using third party applications. Windows Live Messenger in WM 6 has significantly improved now with the ability to have multiperson conversations, add photos, voice clips, and files to conversations. You also now get emoticon support. This application also integrates with your contacts so you can see who is (and who isn't) online at any given time. The integration works smoothly, and the ability to bring over contacts from an online service lets consumers in on something that's previously been restricted to enterprise customers. However this application does not have a cross-service API that would have supported other popular IM services such as Yahoo! and AIM such as the desktop version.

Another aspect of Windows Live for Mobile is the Live Search (Now Bing), giving you a quick and easy way to search the web. When you first access Windows Live, you are given the option of adding a Live Search bar, as well as Windows Live services, to the Today screen.

4.3.5 Office Mobile

Windows Mobile 6 Standard Edition has the full Microsoft Office Mobile Suite. One of the big criticisms of Windows Mobile Standard Edition was its inability to edit Microsoft Office documents. Whereas Windows Mobile 5 smart phones typically came installed with the Pictel Viewer Suite for opening and viewing Word, Excel, and PowerPoint documents, Windows Mobile 6 brings the real deal so you can not only view the files but also edit them. Office Mobile lets you view PowerPoint presentations and view and edit Word and Excel documents. We should note, however, that the editing capabilities are pretty light.

In Word, editing is restricted to inserting and deleting text, and a few very basic formatting commands such as bold, italic, highlight and underline; there's no font



Office Mobile lets you view PowerPoint presentations and view and edit Word and Excel documents.